



RAGHU RAI

Dhirubhai Ambani *(1932-2002)*

Founder, Reliance Industries

Dhirubhai Ambani was one of India's greatest wealth creators. Starting on a meagre seed capital, he went on to build a Rs 60,000 crore giant of a company over the next three and a half decades—an achievement that earned Reliance Industries Ltd a place on the global Fortune 500 list, the first-ever Indian private company to do so. Reliance is the largest producer of petrochemicals in the country and among the top 10 in the world, with the world's largest refinery off-gas cracker complex of 1.5 million tonnes per annum ethylene capacity at Jamnagar in Gujarat. Dhirubhai is widely regarded as the father of India's capital markets. In 1977, when Reliance Textile Industries Ltd first went public, the Indian stock market was a place patronised by a small club of elite investors who dabbled in a handful of stocks. However, Ambani managed to convince a large number of first-time retail investors to participate in the unfolding Reliance, promising them, in exchange for their trust, a substantial return on their investments. It was to be the start of one of the great stories of mutual respect and reciprocal gain in the Indian markets.



Kasturbhai Lalbhai *(1894-1980)*

Lalbhai Group patriarch

One of India's pioneering industrialists of the 20th century, Kasturbhai Lalbhai played an active role in public policy and the establishment of the Indian Institute of Management in Ahmedabad. Born to a business family of Nagarsheths in Jhaveriwad, Ahmedabad, Lalbhai quit his studies at an early age to look after the family business following his father's untimely death. He found his calling in the cotton mill industry and after working at the family's Raipur Mills, he founded several other mills, including Arvind Mills, in 1931. Lalbhai was elected to the Central Legislative Assembly in 1923 and participated in the Swadeshi movement of the 1930s. He was a signatory to the famous Bombay Plan of 1944 that laid a blueprint for economic development in independent India.